

Mongolia



A remote, sparsely populated country that once ruled the largest-ever Asian empire.

1206 **Ghengis Khan** unifies the Mongol tribes and launches a campaign of conquest that is continued by his son and grandson to create a huge empire.

1636 **The Manchu** conquer southern Mongolia, creating Inner Mongolia. Outer Mongolia is offered Manchu protection in 1691.

1911 **Outer Mongolia** declares its independence as Manchu dynasty falls.

1919 **China reoccupies Outer Mongolia.**

1921 **With Red Army** support, Mongolian revolutionaries drive out the Chinese.

1924 **The Mongolian People's Republic**, an independent communist state, is declared.

1966 **Soviet troops** are secretly stationed in Mongolia. They stay until 1986.

1990 **Political parties** are legalized after street demonstrations.

1992 **Former communists**, MPRP, returned to power in first democratic elections, but lose elections in 1996.

1999–2001 **Severe winters** cause widespread hardship.

2008 **President Enkbyar** declares a state of emergency after rioting in the capital.

2010 **Extremely cold** winter kills so many livestock that UN establishes a program to pay herders to collect the carcasses.

«164–65 **Genghis Khan**

North Korea



An isolationist communist regime presides over the impoverished north of the Korean peninsula.

676 CE **The Korean peninsula** is unified under the Kingdom of Silla. Towards the end of the 700s, the kingdom begins to break apart as a result of uprisings and conflicts within the aristocracy.

935 CE **Kingdom of Goryo** is established, once more uniting the peninsula.

1231 **Mongols invade** Goryo.

1392 **Yi Song-gye**, a general under the Goryo regime, deposes the king and founds the Yi dynasty. Two years later, the capital is moved to Seoul.

1636 Korea is invaded by the Manchus, who later go on to conquer China, ruling as the Qing dynasty.

1894–95 **Japan defeats the** Chinese in Korea, beginning the Sino-Japanese War.

1904–05 **Following the Russo-Japanese War**, Japan conquers Korea.

1910 **Japan annexes Korea.**

1919 **Independence protests** are violently suppressed by the Japanese.

1930s **Northern Korea's** industry is developed by the Japanese to supply material for expansion into China.

1945 **Following World War II** Korea splits at 38°N. North is occupied by the USSR.

1946 **KWP (Korean Workers' Party)** is founded. One of its leaders is Kim Il-sung, who has received Red Army training.

1948 **Democratic People's Republic** of Korea created with Kim Il-sung as leader.

1950–53 **The Korean War** begins when Kim Il-sung invades South Korea with the intention of uniting the country. North Koreans take much of the south, before US intervention drives them back. At least 3 million people die.

1950s **Kim Il-sung** starts to develop an extreme personality cult.

1988 **North Korea begins** a repressive process of "ideological rectification."

1991 **North and South Korea** join the UN, and sign basic agreements to foster economic and cultural exchanges.

1994 **Kim Il-sung** dies. He is declared "Eternal President" four years later. His son, Kim Jong-il, succeeds him.

1996 **Famine follows widespread** floods.

1997 **Famine** worsens: estimates of the dead range from 100,000 up to 3 million. Kim Jong-il becomes party leader.

1998 **North Korean mini-submarine** is captured in South Korean waters.

2000 **Kim Jong-il** meets South Korean president Kim Dae-jung in Pyongyang. As a result, a limited number of North Koreans meet relatives from the south, separated since 1950–53, in a reunion.

2002 **Tensions with the US** are heightened as President Bush names North Korea as part of an "Axis of Evil."

2006 **North Korea** tests long-range missiles and claims to have tested a nuclear weapon.

2007 **In a deal struck** in Beijing, North Korea agrees to close its main nuclear reactor in exchange for aid.

2007 **Devastating floods** hit North Korea.

2008 **Relations between** North and South deteriorate. North Korea says it is slowing down the dismantling of its nuclear program.

Border line

Here, UN forces beat a hasty retreat across the 38th parallel, the border between North and South Korea, while retreating from Pyongyang at the outset of the Korean War in 1950.



2009 **North Korea** launches a long-range missile test, and carries out an underground nuclear test. Both tests draw international condemnation.

2009 **A currency reform** provokes unprecedented levels of public protests.

2009 **Sinking of** a South Korean warship, allegedly by northern forces, raises tension. The North Korean Army bombards a South Korean island near Seoul, the worst attack since the Korean War.

«90–91 **Frontiers of Power**

South Korea



The southern half of the peninsula has prospered significantly since the 1950 Korean War.

1945 **US and Soviet** armies arrive. Korea split at 38°N. South comes under de facto US rule.

1948 **Republic of South Korea** is created. Syngman Rhee becomes the first president of an authoritarian regime.

1950 **North Korea** invades, sparking Korean War. The US, with UN backing, enters on the South's side; China unofficially assists the North.

1951 **Fighting stabilizes at** 38th parallel.

1953 **Following an armistice**, a de facto border is established at the ceasefire line.

1960 **Syngman Rhee resigns** in the face of popular revolt (the "April Revolution").

1961 **Military coup leads** to authoritarian junta led by Park Chung-hee.

1963 **After pressure for a civilian** government, Park is reelected as president (also in 1967 and 1971). Strong manufacturing base and exports drive massive economic development.

1965 **Links with** Japan are restored.

1966 **Hundreds of thousands** of troops are deployed in South Vietnam.

1972 **Martial law.** A new constitution confers greater presidential powers.

1979 **Park is assassinated.** General Chun Doo-hwan, intelligence chief, leads coup.

1980 **Chun chosen as** president. Kim Dae-jung arrested.

1987 **Sixth Republic** includes genuine multi-party democracy.

1988 **Seoul hosts** the Olympics.

1991 **South Korea joins** UN.

1992 **Diplomatic links with** China are established. Kim Young-sam is the first civilian president in 30 years.

1998 **Kim Dae-jung** becomes president and pursues a "sunshine policy" of offering aid to North Korea.

2000 **Kim Dae-jung** meets Kim Jong-il in a summit in Pyongyang. Kim Dae-jung awarded Nobel Peace Prize.

2002 **South Korea cohosts** the World Cup with Japan, reaching the semifinals.

2003 **In the biggest** mass-crossing of the border since the war, hundreds of South Koreans visit Pyongyang.

2007 **South Korea** resumes high-level talks with North Korea. Lee Myung-Bak wins presidential elections.

2009 **North and South Korean** warships exchange fire across their disputed maritime frontier.

2010 **South Korea** breaks off trade with North after the sinking of the warship Chaesoon. North Korean army shells South Korean Yeonpyeong island, leading to dangerous rise in tension.

«90–91 **Frontiers of Power**

«170–71 **Korea in the Middle Ages**

«184–85 **The Silk Road**

«456–57 **Tiger Economies**